

FILTER DESIGN TEST CASE

Lattice Filter - WiFi 6E (6 GHz) for Millimeter-Wave Beamforming
Design Validation and Performance Characterization

DOCUMENT INFORMATION

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Author:	Dr. Pierre Dubois
Reviewer:	Dr. Raj Patel
Design Center:	Andover HQ Lab
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1. OBJECTIVE

This document describes the design, simulation, and characterization of a Lattice Filter filter targeting WiFi 6E (6 GHz) for Millimeter-Wave Beamforming. The filter is designed on AlN on SiC substrate with a target center frequency of 1803.5 MHz and bandwidth of 178.5 MHz. The objective is to validate that the filter meets the required insertion loss, rejection, and linearity specifications for integration into the Millimeter-Wave Beamforming module. This design iteration addresses feedback from the previous revision regarding out-of-band rejection improvements and temperature stability.

2. SCOPE

- Filter Type: Lattice Filter
- Frequency Band: WiFi 6E (6 GHz)
- Application: Millimeter-Wave Beamforming
- Substrate: AlN on SiC
- Package: WLP (Wafer Level Package)
- Design Tool: Sonnet EM Suite v16
- Design Center: Andover HQ Lab

This specification applies to all variants of the Lattice Filter design targeting WiFi 6E (6 GHz). Results are used to qualify the design for mass production release.

3. DESIGN PARAMETERS

Center Frequency:	1803.5 MHz
Bandwidth (3 dB):	178.5 MHz
Insertion Loss Target:	≤ 1.6 dB
Return Loss Target:	≥ 16.0 dB
Out-of-Band Rejection:	≥ 38.0 dB
Isolation (Duplexer):	≥ 40.0 dB
Q Factor:	14316
Temperature Coefficient:	-13.5 ppm/°C
Die Size:	2.8 x 2.0 mm
Wafer Size:	6-inch
Number of Resonators:	11
Electrode Material:	Mo

Passivation: SiO2/Si3N4 stack

4. TEST PROCEDURE

1. Open Sonnet EM Suite v16 and load the Lattice Filter template project.
2. Define the substrate stack: AlN on SiC with specified layer thicknesses.
3. Set design targets: center freq 1803.5 MHz, BW 178.5 MHz.
4. Run initial EM simulation with 2D mesh density of 20 cells/wavelength.
5. Optimize resonator geometry using gradient descent (target IL < 1.6 dB).
6. Verify coupling coefficients between resonator stages.
7. Run 3D FEM simulation to account for package parasitics (WLP (Wafer Level Package)).
8. Export GDS-II layout for mask fabrication.
9. Fabricate prototype wafers (6-inch, AlN on SiC).
10. Perform on-wafer probing using Keysight E5080B ENA.
11. Measure S-parameters (S11, S21, S12, S22) from 100 MHz to 5410 MHz.
12. Compare measured results against simulation and specification limits.
13. Perform temperature cycling (-40°C to +85°C) and re-measure.
14. Document results and generate summary report.

5. ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Insertion loss at center frequency shall be <= 1.6 dB
- Return loss in passband shall be >= 16.0 dB
- Out-of-band rejection at +/- 268 MHz offset >= 38.0 dB
- Group delay variation across passband shall be <= 9 ns
- Temperature drift over -40°C to +85°C shall be <= 3.0 MHz
- Power handling shall be >= +33 dBm at 1 dB compression
- ESD tolerance >= 500 V (HBM)
- Die yield on qualification lot >= 91%

6. TEST RESULTS

Measurement Date: 2024-11-04
Devices Tested: 66
Insertion Loss (meas): 1.26 dB
Return Loss (meas): 18.5 dB
Rejection (meas): 41.4 dB
Isolation (meas): 45.5 dB
Q Factor (meas): 14316
Group Delay Variation: 4.9 ns
Power Handling: +28 dBm
Die Yield: 96.6%

Result Classification: CONDITIONAL PASS

7. OBSERVATIONS AND FINDINGS

- a) The Lattice Filter design demonstrated acceptable performance for WiFi 6E (6 GHz).
- b) Insertion loss met target specification.
- c) Out-of-band rejection exceeded the minimum requirement.
- d) Package parasitic effects were consistent with 3D EM model predictions.
- e) Wafer-level uniformity was excellent (sigma < 1.5%).

8. CORRECTIVE ACTIONS

- 1. Review near-band rejection margin for worst-case temperature.
- 2. Re-run EM simulation with refined mesh for better accuracy.
- 3. Schedule follow-up measurement after design tweak.

9. SIGN-OFF

Author:	Dr. Pierre Dubois	Date:	2024-11-04
Reviewer:	Dr. Raj Patel	Date:	2024-11-06
Approver:	Dr. Hans Weber	Date:	2024-11-08

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